CHAPTER FIVE

Antisemitic Terror and Identity Theft

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The intensity of the Middle East blow-back upon the state of antisemitism crossed new thresholds in the summer of 2014. The Jewish condition was impacted by two interconnected prongs—antisemitic terrorism, reinforced by a structured campaign of identity theft (ID theft).

If the purpose of terrorism is to terrorize, the European (and especially French) Jews, have been the favored victims of a Palestinian–Far Left alliance. Let me begin with a personal memory. On October 3, 1980, Erev Sukkoth, I was delivering festive greetings at the home of the late Paris *Maariv* correspondent, Tamar Golan. Her weekend houseguest, Aliza—wife of prominent Jerusalem film-maker Micha Shagrir—had just arrived from Israel. Asking Tamar if she needed anything for dinner, the latter replied: "Perhaps a few figs." Aliza and I took the lift to the street and walked together to the corner. I continued to go straight ahead; Aliza turned into the rue Copernic, towards the fruit shop opposite the synagogue. A few seconds later, she met her death.

The following morning, Prime Minister Raymond Barre publicly stated: "A bomb set for Jews killed four innocent Frenchmen!" In fact, one was a Chinese waiter, another a Portuguese postman, third was Aliza, the fourth an "innocent" Frenchman. Forty-two worshippers were wounded inside the synagogue. The motorbike bomb outside exploded at 6:38 p.m. Had it been thirty minutes later, it would have resulted in a massacre as more than two hundred congregants exited at the end of the service. President Giscard d'Estaing, who refused to return to Paris from a hunting weekend, was to lament in May 1981, "I lost my reelection at Copernic."

The 1980 synagogue bombing launched two years of violence which we might describe as the "antisemitism-terrorism nexus": seventy-three shootings and bombing of Jewish targets across Western Europe, of which twenty-nine were in France. It began with four dead at Copernic and ended with nine gunned down in the rue des Rosiers Jewish quarter of Paris in August 1982.

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Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,